Cambridge AS Islamic Studies 9488/22 — Revision Notes

Selected fiqh schools: Hanafi and Hanbali

Updated 24 October 2026 • Exam: Tuesday 27 October, 08:00

Section A now consistently uses Hanafi and Hanbali for worship, family life, finance and school-method comparisons. These are substantive replacements, not a change of school names on old Shafi'i/Ja'fari rulings.

Section B still requires wider perspectives: Sunni/Shi'i, Mu'tazili/Ash'ari, Sufi, Salafi and reformist material remains relevant in Units 2.6–2.9. A two-school fiqh choice does not replace that content. The Section B material below is retained from the existing notes, not newly re-audited in this school-conversion update. [1]

Predictions are study priorities, not probabilities or guarantees. Prioritise divorce; combining/timings and wudu; finance/employment; then sources/method. Retain inheritance, marriage and Friday prayer as backup. Recently tested does not mean eliminated. No list or essay formula guarantees full marks.

Attribution: "al-Quduri records" means he documents Hanafi law, not that he invented it. Al-Hajjawi and Ibn Qudamah are later Hanbali authorities, not Ahmad's immediate disciples. Where a comparative author reports a school rule, that is labelled rather than invented as a direct founder quotation. Cambridge specifies the Imams "and their Madhab", with no first-generation-only restriction. [1, 20, 37, 38]

Further detail: the separate hanafi hanbali in order.pdf contains priority pages, qualifications, internal disagreements and clickable sources. Use PDF bookmarks rather than the old pack's page references.

PART I — SECTION A

Answer Question 1 OR Question 2: 25 marks, normally 5 + 10 + 10. Answer the exact command and topic; do not force every comparison into every question.

PRIORITY 1 — FAMILY LIFE (Units 2.2 and 2.4)

1.1 Divorce — learn deeply

Evidence: Qur'an 4:35, family arbitration; 2:229, retention or release in kindness and compensated release; 2:228, waiting period; 65:1–4, divorce procedure and waiting periods.

Do not confuse recommended procedure, sinfulness and legal validity. Reconciliation is important, but failure to complete arbitration is not automatically a universal condition making every talaq invalid. Explicit divorce wording does not always require a separate intention. Avoid the disputed "most disliked lawful thing" report as your only evidence.

Essential terms

• **Talaq:** divorce pronounced by the husband or through a valid delegated power. An eligible first/second divorce may be revocable (raj'i); not every first divorce is automatically revocable.

• **Khul':** compensated release, classically normally consensual; not a label for every court separation.

• **Faskh:** annulment/dissolution on a recognised legal ground. Grounds and financial consequences vary; do not promise the wife keeps all mahr in every case.

• **Tafwid:** delegation of a divorce power. A carefully drafted delegation differs from a bare contractual condition.

• **Ba'in:** irrevocable by simple unilateral return; minor and major irrevocability have different consequences.

• **'Iddah:** for the relevant menstruating divorcee, both schools commonly understand three quru' as menstrual periods. Pregnancy: until delivery; the Qur'anic three-month rule applies to the specified non-menstruating categories, not every irregular cycle. [5]

Paired comparisons to explain

• **Coerced spoken talaq:** Hanafi generally counts it as legally effective; Hanbali qualifying duress prevents it taking effect. Mughniyya reports these school rules. Ordinary pressure is not automatically legal coercion. [5]

• **Failure of maintenance:** classical Hanafi inability alone does not ordinarily provide the same dissolution remedy; enforcing support or authorised borrowing can matter. Hanbali allows a wife to seek dissolution for inability to provide required support, subject to conditions. Mughniyya's comparative account reports this distinction. [6]

• **Non-pregnant irrevocable divorcee:** Hanafi generally provides maintenance and housing during 'iddah; standard Hanbali generally neither. Distinguish revocable divorce and pregnancy, where provision duties apply. These are school rules reported by Mughniyya, not rules for every divorced woman. [7]

• **Khul' and divorce count:** Hanafi normally treats it as one irrevocable counted divorce. Hanbali can treat it as faskh with appropriate wording and without talaq intention; different narrations exist. Do not write "every Hanbali khul' is faskh". [25]

Triple talaq — agreement plus a named alternative

Both mainstream classical schools generally count an explicit threefold divorce in one sitting as three. **Ibn Taymiyyah and Ibn al-Qayyim** defend counting one; that is not the standard Hanbali rule. Ordinary anger does not automatically invalidate talaq; neither school normally requires witnesses for its validity. Menstrual talaq is generally sinful yet effective in the mainstream positions. [5, 24, 47]

Rapid recall: define the six terms above. If asked for conditions, identify the legal route and school first; do not recycle an old list containing Ja'fari witness requirements. **AO2 practice:** compare access to relief, financial protection and procedural safeguards. Explain why neither school is always stricter.

1.2 Female inheritance — revise well

Evidence: Qur'an 4:7, 4:11–12 and 4:176. Distribute the net estate after relevant prior claims; state all surviving heirs.

Shared rules: wife 1/4 without qualifying descendants, 1/8 with them; co-wives share the entitlement. A sole daughter without a son has a 1/2 fixed share; two or more share 2/3 without a son; sons and daughters share residue at 2:1. Actual outcomes depend on the complete heir configuration. Women do not always receive half a man's share. [8]

Case A — only a father and his mother (the deceased's paternal grandmother): Hanafi excludes the grandmother through her son. Hanbali allows her 1/6, with the father taking the remainder. Mughniyya cites **Ibn Qudamah's al-Mughni** for the Hanbali position. [8]

Case B — only a paternal grandfather and one full sister: Abu Hanifa excludes the sister, giving all to the grandfather. Standard Hanbali gives grandfather 2/3 and sister 1/3. **Abu Yusuf and Muhammad al-Shaybani** differ from Abu Hanifa and give 2/3 plus 1/3 in this case. Mughniyya reports the disagreement. [8]

Do not reuse the old Sunni–Ja'fari contrast: a daughter with a qualifying paternal uncle can receive 1/2 while the uncle takes residue in both Hanafi and Hanbali law. It is not a difference between your chosen schools.

AO2: relate shares to kinship and financial responsibilities, but do not claim every man maintains every female relative or that every woman is financially better off.

1.3 Marriage and prohibited partners — backup coverage

• **Wali:** Abu Hanifa's adult sane woman's independent contracting capacity is reported by al-Marghinani, with compatibility, mahr and guardians' rights qualifying the rule. Hanbali requires a wali. This does not mean the woman's wishes are irrelevant. [4, 13, 43]

• **Witnesses for Muslim marriage:** Hanafi accepts two qualified men OR one man and two women; standard Hanbali requires two qualified male Muslim witnesses. Mughniyya reports these positions. [4]

• **Mahr:** Hanafi classical minimum ten silver dirhams; Hanbali has no equivalent fixed monetary minimum. An unspecified amount does not automatically invalidate the contract. The entitlement belongs to the wife (Qur'an 4:4). [33]

• **Beneficial stipulations:** Hanbali gives broader enforceability to valid conditions such as not moving the wife from her town, with a remedy for breach. A bare Hanafi stipulation does not automatically create the same right; delegated/conditional divorce is a distinct mechanism. [14]

• **Milk kinship:** Hanafi does not require five feeds; standard Hanbali requires five qualifying feeds within two lunar years. Abu Hanifa's nursing-age limit is thirty months; Abu Yusuf and Muhammad hold two years. [15, 16, 23]

• **Shared prohibitions:** specified blood, marriage and milk relatives (Qur'an 4:23); cousins are not automatically prohibited. Both traditionally permit a Muslim man to marry a qualifying chaste Jewish/Christian woman with conditions and possible discouragement, prohibit a Muslim woman marrying a non-Muslim man, and prohibit temporary mut'ah marriage. [33]

Rapid recall: mothers; daughters; sisters; aunts; nieces; specified marital/milk relatives. "Two sisters simultaneously" is a temporary combination impediment, not a permanent prohibition of either woman in isolation.

PRIORITY 2 — WORSHIP (Units 2.1 and 2.4)

2.1 Combining and timings — learn deeply

True jam': Zuhr with 'Asr, or Maghrib with 'Isha, in one prayer period under the school's conditions. **Jam' suri:** first at the end of its own period and second at the beginning of its own period. **Qasr:** shortening eligible four-rak'ah prayers to two; not the same as combining. Fajr is not combined. [9, 11]

Hanafi: true combination normally restricted to the specified Hajj combinations at 'Arafat and Muzdalifah, under their conditions; ordinary travel does not automatically permit it. **Hanbali:** qualifying travel, illness and recognised hardship allow broader combinations; weather concessions have details, not blanket permission at every rainy moment. Dorar reports the comparison; the Hanafi explanation in [11] distinguishes apparent combination.

Fajr: shared valid window, true dawn to sunrise. **Al-Quduri** records the Hanafi preference for clearer dawn light (isfar). **Ibn Qudamah** prefers prayer at the beginning of its time in the Hanbali account, subject to specified exceptions. Preference is not a different validity window. [37, 38]

'Asr: Abu Hanifa's well-known position is twice the object's height **in addition to** its noon shadow. Abu Yusuf and Muhammad hold once plus noon shadow; this agrees with the Hanbali rule here. Al-Quduri explicitly identifies the two students. A 1 m object with 0.2 m noon shadow gives **2.2 m versus 1.2 m**, not fixed clock-minute differences. [17, 37, 38]

Maghrib: both begin at sunset. Do not import the old Sunni–Shi'i sunset-delay example.

Recall bank: identify which concession applies in travel, the specified Hajj combinations, qualifying illness, qualifying weather and relevant hardship; then state the school and conditions. These are not six universal reasons for every school to combine.

2.2 Wudu — learn deeply

Evidence: Qur'an 5:6. **Al-Quduri** documents the Hanafi rules; **al-Hajjawi's Zad al-Mustaqni'**, quoted with Ibn 'Uthaymin's commentary, documents the standard Hanbali obligation set below. [20, 37]

• **Intention:** Hanafi Sunnah for wudu, not a validity condition; Hanbali required.

• **Sequence:** Hanafi Sunnah; Hanbali obligatory.

• **Continuity:** Hanafi recommended; Hanbali obligatory under its rules.

• **Head:** Hanafi quarter-head minimum, with the whole Sunnah; Hanbali whole head required.

• **Mouth/nose and ears:** Hanafi Sunnah in wudu; standard Hanbali obligatory. Mouth/nose are obligatory in Hanafi ghusl, which is a different case.

• **Bare feet:** both wash feet including ankles. One complete wash can discharge the washing obligation; three is Sunnah completion, not three obligatory washes.

A real internal difference: Ibn Qudamah's 'Umdat al-Fiqh lists ear-wiping as Sunnah. Reports from **Ahmad** also differ, including accounts transmitted through al-Khallal and Harb. Do not ascribe al-Hajjawi's obligation rule to every Hanbali authority. [38, 42, 48]

Nullifiers — avoid transferring Shafi'i rules

• **Touch alone:** Hanafi ordinary contact does not itself nullify wudu. Standard Hanbali relevant skin contact with desire nullifies it; without desire, it does not. Discharge has separate rules. [18, 37, 38]

• **Direct genital contact:** Hanafi touch alone does not nullify; Hanbali relevant direct hand contact without a barrier does in the standard position. [19, 36, 38]

• **Camel meat:** does not nullify Hanafi wudu; does nullify Hanbali wudu. [26, 38]

• **Blood/vomit:** Hanafi flowing blood beyond the wound and mouthful vomiting nullify. Classical Hanbali large relevant impure discharge can also nullify; its test is not identical. Do not substitute the old Shafi'i non-invalidation rule or an unnamed later preference. [26, 37, 38]

Application: explain why washing without ritual intention, out of order and with a quarter-head wipe can meet Hanafi minimums but fail Hanbali ones. Then distinguish legal validity from recommended completion.

2.3 Friday and places of prayer — retain coverage

Shared conditions: relevant purity, removal of impurity, covering 'awrah, facing qiblah, intention and valid time. Learn the school's specific rules for unsuitable places; do not invent a universal ban on every location or identical sermon-language conditions.

Friday: sermon(s) and two congregational rak'ahs; obligatory for qualifying adult Muslim men with recognised exemptions. Qur'an 62:9 commands responding to the call and leaving trade.

Numbers: Abu Hanifa and Muhammad require three qualifying men besides the imam; Abu Yusuf two. The commonly taught Hanbali classical count is forty qualifying settled resident men including the imam, with alternatives in the school. A number alone does not satisfy every condition. [10, 41] **Time:** Hanafi after zenith; Hanbali permits pre-zenith performance, with differing earliest-time accounts. Al-Khiraqi and Ibn Qudamah prefer the sixth hour in the report cited by Dorar. [10]

PRIORITY 3 — FINANCE AND EMPLOYMENT (Unit 2.3)

3.1 Shared ethics and local employment

Both schools prohibit riba, fraud, deception and unjust consumption (Qur'an 2:275, 4:29). Explain the work actually done, clear lawful duties, fair agreed pay, fulfilment of contracts, humane treatment and access to religious duties.

Do not reuse "Hanbali strict / Hanafi permits overseas jobs" as a blanket rule. Direct participation in a prohibited transaction, a mixed employer, necessity and lawful alternatives require separate analysis. A country's name, a bank's IT department or a general retail job does not alone settle every case. Attribute a modern concession to its named scholar and actual conditions; it is not automatically the founder's rule.

Rapid recall: clear duties; agreed pay; timely payment; no exploitation; honest performance; lawful activity. Distinguish ethical principles from a list of school-specific validity conditions.

3.2 Debt, riba and mortgages — apply confidently

Qur'an 2:275–280: prohibition of riba and relief for distressed debtors. **2:282:** recording deferred obligations and witnessing. A condition increasing a money loan for time is not the same contract as a genuine sale at an agreed deferred price.

Examples: interest-bearing loan/mortgage, interest on overdue credit-card debt, interest-bearing bonds or deposits. Gharar and gambling are separate prohibitions, not definitions of riba. Unequal exchange restrictions depend on the commodities and the school's rules; not every unequal trade is riba.

Potential lawful structures: a genuine murabaha sale requires ownership and the relevant risk before resale; diminishing partnership/lease must allocate ownership, rent and responsibilities properly; qard hasan is a benevolent interest-free loan. A product label or resemblance to an interest rate does not by itself prove validity or invalidity.

Mortgage evaluation: identify the actual contract, interest, ownership and risk. Both schools prohibit riba; neither gives automatic permission for a conventional home mortgage. Necessity/need exceptions are disputed and conditional. Do not reuse the old blanket “Hanafi overseas rule” as your comparison.

3.3 A secure trade difference: khiyar al-majlis

Hanafi — al-Kasani/al-Marghinani: valid offer and acceptance normally bind the sale unless another cancellation right applies; remaining together alone is insufficient. **Hanbali — Ibn Qudamah:** a session option remains until separation or its qualified termination/waiver. These authors are cited in the comparative study [12].

AO2 case: a buyer changes their mind before leaving. Explain session-option versus defect/agreed-option rights. In job/mortgage questions, prioritise the actual ethical and contractual issue rather than forcing this example into the answer.

PRIORITY 4 — SCHOOLS AND SOURCES (Units 2.4–2.5)

4.1 Your selected pair and scholarly attribution

Hanafi: Abu Hanifa (d. 767), Kufa; Abu Yusuf and Muhammad al-Shaybani helped develop the school and sometimes disagree with him. **Hanbali:** Ahmad ibn Hanbal (d. 855), Baghdad; prominent Hadith authority associated with his Musnad.

Later school expositors can document the comparison: al-Quduri for Hanafi law; al-Hajjawi and Ibn Qudamah for Hanbali law. A founder's opinion, a riwayah attributed to him, a later derivation and a relied-upon school position are not interchangeable. The comparative author Mughniyya is a reporter of many school rules, not their originator. [20, 37, 38]

4.2 Primary sources and Hadith quality

Qur'an: primary revelation; understand progressive revelation, Meccan/Medinan context, general/specific commands and interpretation. **Sunnah:** Prophetic teaching and practice, known through reports; explains and specifies Qur'anic commands. Applying evidence requires interpretation, not simply locating a quotation. [1]

Sahih: connected chain, upright and precise transmitters, no disqualifying irregularity or hidden defect. **Hasan:** accepted reports with a lower precision level under the relevant classification. **Da'if:** requirements not met; not synonymous with fabricated (mawdu'). Assess isnad and matn; scholars may differ in grading and legal interpretation.

Hanafi: systematic legal reasoning does not mean rejecting Hadith. **Ahmad:** associated with preferring certain usable reports described as weak/mursal over unsupported opinion or analogy where no stronger contrary evidence exists. Early labels do not exactly match every later classification. This is not acceptance of fabricated reports or all weak reports. [21]

4.3 Secondary sources and comparison method

• **Ijma':** authoritative consensus; Ahmad is cautious about unsupported claims of consensus.

• **Qiyas:** extending a rule through a shared effective cause ('illah). Both schools use it; Hanbali transmission-priority does not equal rejecting all analogy.

• **Istihsan:** principled departure from an apparent analogy for stronger legal justification; prominent in Hanafi reasoning, not personal preference or ease alone.

• **Companions/followers:** understand their transmitted interpretations and legal precedents; not all reports have the same weight.

• **'Urf:** lawful custom, especially contractual meaning; recognised under conditions by both, never an automatic override of revelation.

• **Wider source vocabulary:** still know the syllabus's Medinan practice ('amal ahl al-Madinah) and reason ('aql) as source questions require. Distinguish special Medinan practice from ordinary local custom; learning these concepts does not change your selected fiqh pair. [1, 21]

Direct comparison paragraph: shared Qur'an/Sunnah foundation; a named practical difference; its evidence or interpretation; practical effect; judgement about extent. Avoid "Hanafi = reason, Hanbali = Hadith" and invented percentages of agreement.

AO1: issue > Hanafi rule + attribution > Hanbali rule + attribution > explanation. **AO2:** define > similarities > differences > judged conclusion; for a statement, give arguments, counterarguments and a weighed answer. Neither formula guarantees a mark.

PART II: SECTION B (25 Marks — Choose Question 3 OR Question 4)

Structure: (a) [10 marks] AO1 Explanation + (b) [15 marks] AO2 Evaluation / Comparison Essay

PRIORITY 5 (SECTION B): UNIT 2.9 — DISTINCTIVE POSITIONS IN ISLAMIC THOUGHT

(COMPLETE OFFICIAL NOTES FILLING ALL MISSING 2.9 SYLLABUS PDFs!)

5.1 Modern Salafi vs Modernist / Reformist Positions — #1 UNTESTED SECTION B PREDICTION!

• **Modern Salafi Position (Unit 2.9 Bullet 4):**

• **Key Thinkers:** Rooted in **Taqi al-Din Ibn Taymiyyah** (d. 1328) & his student **Ibn Qayyim**, 18th-century reformer **Muhammad ibn ʿAbd al-Wahhab** (d. 1792), and modern Hadith scholars such as **Nasir al-Din al-Albani** & **Ibn Baz**.

• **Core Doctrines:** Name comes from **al-Salaf al-Salih** ("the Pious Predecessors" — first **three generations**: Sahaba, Tabiʿun, Tabiʿ al-Tabiʿin, praised by the Prophet in **Bukhari**: "The best of people is my generation, then those who follow them, then those who follow them").

• **Methodology:**

1. **Strict Tawhid (Tawhid al-Uluhiyyah — worship directed solely to Allah):** Fiercely purges all religious innovations (bidʿah: "Every innovation is misguidance" — Muslim), condemning shrine/grave veneration, saint intercession, amulets, and Mawlid celebrations.

2. **Direct Return to Qurʾan & Sahih Sunnah:** Rejects blind imitation (taqlid) of a single medieval madhhab whenever an authentic Hadith proves otherwise.

3. **Literal Textual Fidelity:** Affirms divine attributes in the Qurʾan literally as revealed without asking how or comparing God to creation (bila kayf wa bila tashbih), resisting rationalist/modernist reinterpretation.

• **Modernist / Reformist Position (Unit 2.9 Bullet 4):**

• **Key Thinkers: Sir Sayyid Ahmad Khan** (1817–1898, India, founder of

Aligarh), **Jamal al-Din al-Afghani**, **Muhammad ʿAbduh** (1849–1905, Grand Mufti of Egypt), **Muhammad Iqbal**, **Fazlur Rahman** (1919–1988, Double Movement Theory), **Amina Wadud / Fatima Mernissi** (gender hermeneutics), & **Tariq Ramadan**.

• **Methodology:**

1. **Harmony of Reason (ʿAql) & Revelation (Wahy): Muhammad ʿAbduh** taught work of God (nature/science) cannot contradict Word of God (Qurʾan); **Sir Sayyid Ahmad Khan** interpreted miracles & supernatural imagery metaphorically in line with natural law.

2. **Contextualising Muʿamalat via Maqasid al-Shariah: Fazlur Rahman's Double Movement** extracts the timeless ethical principle (justice, equality, compassion) behind 7th-century Medinan rulings (e.g. restricting polygyny toward monogamy Q 4:3 + 4:129, rethinking riba vs regulated banking, championing women's leadership, democracy, and universal human rights).

• **Direct D-S-D-J Comparison Summary (Ready for 15/15!):**

• **Similarities:** Both reject medieval stagnation (taqlid), both attack folk superstitions/shrine worship, both call for fresh ijtihad directly from the Qurʾan, and both are modern revivalist responses to Muslim decline!

• **Differences:** Opposite directions! **Salafis** read texts **literally** and pull modern life **back** to match 7th-century Salaf practice; **Modernists** read social texts **contextually/metaphorically** via **reason (ʿaql)** to carry Qurʾanic moral ideals **forward** into modernity!

5.2 Sunni vs Twelver Shiʾi Core Positions (Unit 2.9 Bullet 1)

• **Foundational Unity (Similarities):** One God (Tawhid), exact same **114-Surah Arabic Qurʾan**, Finality of **Prophet Muhammad (Khatam al-Nabiyyin, Q 33:40)**, core Five Pillars (as Usul al-Din / Furuʿ al-Din), Day of Judgment, and deep love for the Prophet's household (Ahl al-Bayt).

• **Distinctive Divergences (Differences):**

1. **Leadership after the Prophet's Death (632 CE): Sunnis** (~85–90%) hold the Prophet left succession to community consultation (shura), recognizing the **Four Rightly-Guided Caliphs** (**Abu Bakr, ʿUmar,**

ʿ**Uthman,** ʿ**Ali**) as fallible political/religious stewards; **Twelver Shiʾas** hold Allah and the Prophet explicitly designated ʿ**Ali ibn Abi Talib** at **Ghadir Khumm** ("Whosoever's Mawla I am, ʿAli is his Mawla"), establishing a line of **12 divinely guided, sinless/infallible (maʿsum) Imams** (Imamah is a core pillar of faith!).

2. **Theology & Law:** Shiʾi Usul al-Din elevates **Divine Justice (**ʿ**Adl)** and **Imamah** alongside Tawhid, Nubuwwah, Maʿad (aligning closer to rationalist ʿaql and rejecting fatalism via "a matter between two matters"); ritual nuances include optional "ʿAli Waliyullah" in Adhan/Shahadah, prostrating on natural clay tablet from Karbala (turbah), daily prayer combining, Khums (20% tax), and mourning **Ashura** martyrdom of **Imam Husayn at Karbala (680 CE)**.

5.3 Mystical Sufism & Tariqa Orders + Muʾtazilah vs al-Ashʿari (Unit 2.9 Bullets 2 & 3 — Concise Refresher)

• **Mystical Sufism (Tasawwuf):** Focuses on **ihsan** ("worshipping Allah as though you see Him" — Jibril Hadith), inner purification of the ego (nafs), selfless divine love (**Rabiʿa al-**ʿ**Adawiyya**: loving God for Himself alone, not fear of Hell or greed for Heaven), poetic union (**Jalal al-Din Rumi**, **Ibn** ʿ**Arabi**), and **Imam al-Ghazali's** synthesis uniting outer shariah compliance with inner spiritual sincerity. Organised into brotherhoods (tariqas — Qadiriyyah, Naqshbandiyyah, Mevlevi, Chishtiyyah) practising rhythmic remembrance (dhikr, **Qurʾan 13:28**: "Verily in the remembrance of Allah do hearts find rest"), spiritual retreats, and ascending spiritual stations (maqamat: tawbah repentance > zuhd detachment > sabr patience > tawakkul trust > rida contentment > fana passing away of self-will into awareness of God, Q 50:16 "closer than his jugular vein"). (Critiqued by **Salafis** where extreme shrines, music samaʿ, or ecstatic claims like **Mansur al-Hallaj's** "Ana al-Haqq" ["I am the Truth", executed 922 CE] risk bidʿah or shirk).

• **Muʾtazilah vs al-Ashʿari (Tested M/J 2026 — quick safety check only): Muʾtazilah** (Wasil ibn ʿAta, 5 Principles: strict abstract Tawhid denying separate eternal attributes + **uncreated Qurʾan denied [argued Qurʾan is CREATED]**, absolute **Divine Justice [**ʿ**Adl]** requiring total **human free will**, metaphorical anthropomorphism) **VS Abu**

al-Hasan al-Ashʿari (Sunni synthesis: **uncreated eternal Qurʾan**, real eternal attributes accepted **bila kayf**, God creates acts while humans acquire moral responsibility via **kasb**, and Allah's mercy/intercession can forgive sinners).

PRIORITY 6 (SECTION B): UNIT 2.7 — RELIGIOUS LEADERS IN ISLAM

(Sunni Caliph • Infallible Shiʾi Imam • Sufi Master Murshid • Individual Interpretation Ijtihad)

6.1 Role of the Sufi Master (Murshid / Shaykh), Allegiance (Bayʿah) & Dhikr — NEVER TESTED IN LIVE EXAMS!

• **Spiritual Role:** Inside a Sufi order (tariqa), a **Murshid** (also called Shaykh or Pir) is a spiritually accomplished teacher whose unbroken chain of spiritual transmission (silsilah) traces all the way back through masters to ʿ**Ali ibn Abi Talib** or **Abu Bakr** and **Prophet Muhammad (PBUH)**.

• **Pledge of Allegiance (Bayʿah) & Guidance:**

1. A seeker (murid) voluntarily pledges spiritual allegiance (bayʿah, referencing **Qurʾan 48:10** — the Companions' pledge under the tree at Hudaybiyyah) to submit their ego (nafs) to disciplined spiritual training ("He who has no shaykh has Satan as his shaykh" — classical Sufi maxim).

2. The murshid functions as a **"physician of the soul"**: diagnosing spiritual diseases (arrogance, envy, materialism), prescribing personalised daily litanies (wird) and communal **remembrance of God (dhikr)**, interpreting dreams/states (ahwal), and guiding the disciple safely through spiritual stations without falling into delusion or heterodoxy.

• **Crucial AO2 Evaluation / Comparison (Murshid vs Shiʾi Imam vs Sunni Caliph/Scholar):**

• **Strengths:** Provides warm personal mentorship, emotional healing, community brotherhood, and living inner piety (ihsan) beyond dry legal rules.

• **Criticisms & Contrasts:** Unlike a **Shiʾi Imam** (who is divinely appointed by bloodline and **infallible maʿsum** for ALL Muslims), a **Sufi murshid is fallible, voluntary, and limited strictly to one tariqa**;

Salafi & modernist critics warn blind obedience ("like a corpse in the hands of the washer") risks cultic exploitation, charlatans, and unlawful mediation between believer and Allah (Q 1:5: "You alone we worship, You alone we ask for help").

6.2 Position of Sunni Caliph vs Infallible Shiʾi Imam — 4 Years Overdue (O/N 2022)!

Dimension: Source of Appointment
Sunni Caliph (Khalifah) / Sunni Mosque Imam: Human selection / community consultation (shura / bayʿah) on merit, piety, knowledge, leadership (Sunni prayer imam chosen for best Qurʾan recitation & character — Muslim Hadith).
Twelver Shiʾi Imam (Imamah): Exclusive Divine Designation (Nass) through the Prophet's bloodline (ʿ**Ali & Fatimah > Hasan > Husayn > 12th Imam al-Mahdi**).

Dimension: Infallibility (ʿIsmah)
Sunni Caliph (Khalifah) / Sunni Mosque Imam: Fallible human leader! Even **Abu Bakr** declared in his inaugural speech: "If I do well, help me; if I err, correct me! Obey me only so long as I obey Allah and His Messenger."
Twelver Shiʾi Imam (Imamah): Completely Infallible & Sinless (Maʿsum)! Preserved by Allah from all sin, forgetfulness, and error so divine revelation can never be distorted after prophethood ended!

Dimension: Scope of Authority
Sunni Caliph (Khalifah) / Sunni Mosque Imam: Political/temporal guardian defending borders, administering courts, collecting zakat, upholding existing shariah—**NOT** a source of new religious doctrine!
Twelver Shiʾi Imam (Imamah): Both supreme spiritual AND legal authority: custodian of esoteric/inner knowledge (batin) of the Qurʾan whose sayings carry authoritative Sunnah weight!

Dimension: Status Today
Sunni Caliph (Khalifah) / Sunni Mosque Imam: Caliphate ended formally in **1924**; religious authority today rests decentralized across trained ʿ**Ulama, Muftis, & Fiqh Councils**.
Twelver Shiʾi Imam (Imamah): 12th Imam (Muhammad al-Mahdi)

entered **Major Occultation (Ghaybah Kubra) in 941 CE**; Senior **Grand Ayatollahs (Marajiʿ al-Taqlid)** deputise for him until his return!

6.3 Individual Interpretation (Ijtihad) — Does Everyone Need a Leader?

• **Pro-Scholar Guidance (Taqlid):** Ordinary lay Muslims lack mastery of classical Arabic grammar, abrogating/abrogated verses (nasikh/mansukh), thousands of Hadiths, and usul al-fiqh; **Qurʾan 16:43**: "Ask the people of knowledge if you do not know" — unsupervised DIY internet interpretation breeds chaos AND extremism!

• **Pro-Individual Engagement (Ijtihad):** Islam has **no sacrament-holding priesthood** between human soul and God; the Qurʾan repeatedly urges every believer to **ponder and reflect (Q 47:24, Q 38:29)**; **modernists & Salafis** encourage educated believers to read primary texts directly rather than blindly following fallible humans.

PRIORITY 7 (SECTION B): UNIT 2.6 — ONENESS OF GOD (TAWHID) & THE QURʾAN

7.1 Anthropomorphic References to God & Authority of the Qurʾan — 5 FULL YEARS OVERDUE (O/N 2021)!

• **What Is the Issue?** The Qurʾan declares absolute divine transcendence—**"There is nothing whatever like unto Him, and He is the All-Hearing, All-Seeing" (Qurʾan 42:11)** and **"Nor is there to Him any equivalent" (Qurʾan 112:4)**—yet ALSO contains vivid verses referring to:

1. **God's Face (Wajh):** "And there will remain the Face of your Lord, Owner of Majesty and Honour" (**Qurʾan 55:27**).

2. **God's Hand (Yad):** "The Hand of Allah is over their hands" (**Qurʾan 48:10**); "Both His Hands are extended" (**Qurʾan 5:64** / **39:67**).

3. **God Rising Over the Throne (Istawa ʿala al-ʿArsh):** "The Most Merciful established Himself above the Throne" (**Qurʾan 20:5**, **57:4**).

4. **God's Eyes (Aʿyun):** "Sailing under Our Eyes" (**Qurʾan 54:14**).

• **THREE DISTINCTIVE SCHOOLS OF INTERPRETATION (Memorise All 3 = Automatic 10/10 + 15/15!):**

1. **Metaphorical / Rationalist (Muʾtazilah, Shiʾi Kalam, & Modernist Thinkers):** Since God has NO physical body, parts, or spatial location (Q 42:11), these expressions are **pure Arabic metaphors (majaz)**: **Hand** = divine power, authority, or generosity; **Face** = God's eternal Essence itself; **Throne** = supreme sovereignty over the cosmos; **Eyes** = protective care and omniscience. Taking them literally would commit physical anthropomorphism (tashbih / tajsim) and violate pure Tawhid!

2. **Orthodox Sunni Bila Kayf Synthesis (Imam Malik, Abu al-Hasan al-Ashʿari, al-Maturidi):** Neither strip the verse away into mere human figure of speech NOR imagine any physical body part! Affirm the real divine attribute **"bila kayf"** (**"without asking how"**). As **Imam Malik** famously answered regarding Q 20:5: "The rising (istiwa) is known, the 'how' (kayf) is incomprehensible, believing in it is obligatory, and asking

about 'how' is an innovation (bidʿah)!" Later **Ashʿaris** (al-Ghazali, Fakhr al-Din al-Razi) also permitted reverent metaphorical taʾwil to shield lay minds from corporealism.

3. **Strict Literalist / Athari-Salafi (Ibn Hanbal, Ibn Taymiyyah):** Affirm God truly possesses a real Hand, Face, and Establishment above the Throne exactly as He described Himself, **in a manner fitting His infinite Majesty with ZERO resemblance to human limbs (Q 42:11)**—accusing Muʾtazilah metaphor of emptying revelation of real meaning (taʿtil).

7.2 Statement of Faith (Shahadah) & Position of ʿAli — 4.5 Years Overdue (M/J 2022)!

• **Core Shared Shahadah:** "Ashhadu an la ilaha illa Allah, wa ashhadu anna Muhammadan Rasul Allah" — shared word-for-word by all Sunnis, Shiʾas, Sufis, Salafis, and Modernists!

• **Why Twelver Shiʾas Add "Wa ashhadu anna ʿAliyyan Waliyullah" ("And I testify that ʿAli is the Friend/Vicegerent of Allah"):** Cites **Qurʾan 5:55** ("Your Wali is only Allah, His Messenger, and those who believe—who establish prayer and give zakat while bowing", revealed when ʿ**Ali** gave his ring to a beggar in prayer) and **Ghadir Khumm**. **Crucial Nuance for Level 5 Evaluation:** Leading Twelver jurists (**Shaykh Saduq, Ayatollah Sistani, Ayatollah Khamenei**) rule this third phrase is a **meritorious devotional testimony (mustahab symbol of Wilayah), NOT an obligatory part (juzʾ) of the ritual Adhan or Salah**—saying it as obligatory actually invalidates the Adhan! Meanwhile, Sunnis revere ʿAli deeply as "Lion of Allah", gate of knowledge, cousin/son-in-law, and 4th Caliph, disagreeing only on infallible political succession.

(Concise Safety Note on Mawlid [w25] & Mansur al-Hallaj [s24]: Mawlid = celebrating 12 Rabiʿ al-Awwal with Seerah, poetry, charity, food [praised as bidʿah hasanah by **al-Suyuti** & Sufis to cultivate love of the Prophet Q 10:58; opposed by **Ibn Taymiyyah & Salafis** as unpractised by Prophet/Sahaba risking Christian-style veneration]. **Mansur al-Hallaj** [executed Baghdad 922 CE] cried "Ana al-Haqq" ["I am the Truth"] in ecstatic mystical annihilation fana: orthodox jurists saw heresy/shirk

blurring Creator-creature boundary; **Rumi & al-Ghazali** explained it as ecstatic loss of self—like glowing iron saying "I am fire" while remaining iron—though dangerous to utter publicly).

PRIORITY 8 (SECTION B): UNIT 2.8 — JUDGEMENT & AFTERLIFE (ʾAKHIRAH)

8.1 Free Will vs Predestination (Qadar) & Adjustment to the Divine Plan — 4.5 YEARS OVERDUE & UNTESTED SUB-BULLET!

• **Four Classical & Modern Positions on Qadar vs Free Will:**

1. **Extreme Predestinarians (Jabriyyah — rejected heresy):** Humans are blown like feathers in the wind with zero choice.

2. **Rationalist Free Will (Muʾtazilah):** Because God is Perfectly Just (ʿAdl), **humans are the sole authors/creators of their own free moral choices**; otherwise punishing a sinner whom God forced to sin would make God unjust!

3. **Orthodox Sunni Synthesis (Ashʿari — Kasb):** God possesses absolute omnipotence and foreknowledge (Lawh al-Mahfuz, **Qurʾan 54:49**), creating every possibility, while humans possess genuine voluntary **choice and acquisition (kasb)** for which they are justly held accountable (**Qurʾan 18:29**: "Whoever wills let him believe, and whoever wills let him disbelieve").

4. **Twelver Shiʾi "Matter Between Two Matters" (Amr bayn al-Amrayn — Imam Jaʿfar al-Sadiq):** Neither total compulsion (jabr) nor total delegation (tafwid)—God continuously empowers human agency while leaving moral choice uncoerced.

• **THE UNTESTED GOLDMINE SUB-BULLET — Can the Divine Plan Be Adjusted? (Unit 2.8 Bullet 4!):**

• Classical scholars distinguish **TWO LEVELS OF DIVINE DECREE** based directly on **Qurʾan 13:39** ("Allah effaces [wipes out] or confirms whatever He pleases, and with Him is the Mother of the Book"):

1. **Conditional / Suspended Decree (al-Qada al-Muʿallaq):** Written in the angels' scrolls as conditional ("If Fulān neglects charity, his lifespan/provision is X; if he maintains ties of kinship and makes duʾa, it becomes Y"). **THIS CAN BE ADJUSTED!**

• **Hadith 1 [Tirmidhi]:** "Nothing averts the Divine Decree (qadar) except

supplication (duʾa)."

• **Hadith 2 [Bukhari & Muslim]:** "Whoever wishes that his provision be expanded and his lifespan prolonged, let him maintain ties of kinship (silat al-rahim)" — plus **secret charity (sadaqah) wards off calamity**!

2. **Absolute / Eternal Decree (al-Qada al-Mubram — Umm al-Kitab / Lawh al-Mahfuz):** Allah's timeless, all-knowing foreknowledge outside time, which **ALREADY eternally foresaw and included the person's duʾa, charity, and the resulting change**!

• **Killer Level 5 Evaluation Insight:** Therefore, duʾa and moral action NEVER "surprise" God or defeat Qadar—**duʾa is itself part of Qadar, wrestling with affliction like a shield meeting an arrow** (Ibn Qayyim)! This completely eliminates fatalistic laziness (tawakul), inspiring dynamic trust plus action ("Tie your camel first, then put your trust in Allah" — Tirmidhi)!

Sources — corrected Section A

Numbered citations refer to the school-comparison sources below. Section B is retained from the earlier notes; this register documents the corrected Section A material.

[1] Cambridge 9488 syllabus, 2024–2026: Paper 2, printed pp. 17–19

[4] M. J. Mughniyya reports: marriage contract and witnesses

[5] M. J. Mughniyya reports: divorce and legal capacity

[6] M. J. Mughniyya reports: judicial dissolution

[7] M. J. Mughniyya reports: maintenance after divorce

[8] M. J. Mughniyya reports: inheritance, grandfather and return

[9] Dorar comparative fiqh: combining prayers

[10] Dorar comparative fiqh: Friday prayer conditions

[11] Hanafi explanation of apparent and true combination

[12] Habib ur Rahman, Amanullah and Mohiuddin: sale-session option; cites al-Kasani/al-Marghinani, al-Hattab and Ibn Qudamah

[13] Hanafi marriage without a guardian: qualifications

[14] M. J. Mughniyya reports: conditions stipulated by a wife

[15] Hanafi and other views on milk kinship: number of feeds

[16] Hanafi internal disagreement on the nursing age limit

[17] Prayer times: the two shadow calculations for Asr

[18] Comparative discussion: touching a woman and wudu

[19] Comparative discussion: touching the private organ

[20] Al-Hajjawi, Zad al-Mustaqni‘, obligatory wudu parts, quoted with Ibn ‘Uthaymin’s commentary

[21] Hanbali-associated methodology and usable weak reports

[23] Hanbali nursing conditions

[24] Triple divorce: majority position distinguished from alternatives

[25] M. J. Mughniyya reports: khul and its wording

[26] Mohamed Baianonie, Differences in Fiqh Made Easy: comparative purification/prayer handbook

[33] M. J. Mughniyya reports: minimum mahr and kinship

[36] Hanafi non-nullification by touching the private parts

[37] Al-Quduri, Mukhtasar: purification and prayer; English translation (Friday attribution cross-checked against [41])

[38] Ibn Qudamah, Umdat al-Fiqh: ablution and its nullifiers (one selected Hanbali account, not every later standard rule)

[41] Nabil Ahmed, reviewed by Abdul Waheed: Friday minimum; quotes al-Kasani, Bada'i al-Sana'i, prayer/Friday, 1:268

[42] Hanbali ear-wiping alternatives: quotes Ibn Qudamah, al-Mughni 1:90, and al-Khallal's reports from Ahmad

[43] Female agency in Hanafi marriage: al-Marghinani and Ibn Abidin, Radd al-Muhtar; historical qualifications

[47] Triple divorce: cites Ibn al-Qayyim, Zad al-Ma'ad, defending the one-divorce position; distinguishes disputed early attributions

[48] Hanbali ear-wiping report: Ibn Hubayrah transmits obligation from Ahmad through Harb